

The State of *Configurable* • Product Manufacturing Websites

How configurable-product manufacturers lose buyers online, a 100-company website audit.

AT A GLANCE

What **100** Manufacturer Websites Tell You

The condensed version of this report, in five numbers and three sentences.

26%

have a homepage configurator. 46% have nothing visible.

15%

display product pricing without a transactional barrier. 67% gate every dollar figure.

12%

have a low-friction quote-request form. 72% bury the form behind clicks or login.

9_x

Channel-locked vs. direct/hybrid

median Buyer Enablement Score gap — 0.50 vs. 4.50, the strongest predictor in the dataset.

IN A SENTENCE

Most enterprise manufacturer websites send every buyer to a phone tree. The few that do not (**15 of 100**, led by Yale Commercial and ClosetMaid at a Buyer Enablement Score of 7.50) preserve their dealer channel through a different mechanism rather than by hiding the price.

Closing the gap does not require dismantling the dealer model. It requires giving the website the same job a dealer does: helping a buyer figure out what to buy.

SPONSORSHIP DISCLOSURE

Threekit commissioned and funded this research. The Buyer Enablement Score components and weights were set by the research team and are published in full. Threekit had no editorial review rights over findings, scoring, or rankings. Per-component scores for the top 10 leaders are published alongside the composite so readers can apply alternative weightings.

FOREWORD

What We're Seeing

For decades, the way enterprise manufacturers sold complex products was simple. A buyer found a brand. The brand handed them a catalog. The catalog reached a dealer. The dealer closed the sale.

That model still works in some places. It works less well almost everywhere else. The buyer who arrives on a manufacturer's website today has already done much of what a dealer used to do. They've researched alternatives, narrowed options, and looked for prices. What they haven't done is fill out a form and wait three days for a callback.

Across this audit of 100 enterprise manufacturers, the gap between what buyers expect online and what manufacturers actually deliver is the most consistent finding. The median Buyer Enablement Score across the cohort is 2.25 out of 10.

The harder question is how manufacturers do more on the website without disintermediating the channels that still close most of the revenue. A few sites in this audit point to a working pattern. The website does the early work. The channel still closes the deal.

We hope this report is useful to the manufacturers in our cohort and to the broader category.



Matt Gorniak

CEO, Threekit

ABOUT THIS RESEARCH

How and Why We Ran This Audit

This research was commissioned by Threekit to examine the state of buyer experience on enterprise manufacturer websites — what an actual buyer encounters when they land on a manufacturer's homepage and try to figure out what to buy.

SPONSORSHIP AND METHODOLOGY DISCLOSURE

Threekit commissioned and funded this research. The Buyer Enablement Score components and weights were set by the research team and are published in full in section 02 and the methodology section. Threekit had no editorial review rights over findings, scoring, or rankings. Per-component scores are published alongside the composite so readers can apply alternative weightings.

BY THE NUMBERS

100

configurable-product
manufacturers in
cohort

10

audit data
points per
site

84

sites yielding
usable audit
data

16

sites excluded
(bot-blocks, JS
shells, SSL
errors)

THE COHORT

We selected 100 of the largest and most recognizable configurable-product manufacturing companies in North America, spanning Doors & Windows, Kitchen & Bath / Plumbing, Cabinets & Closets, Contract Furniture, Medical & Dental Equipment, Custom Uniforms / PPE, Powersports, Heavy Machinery, Foodservice Equipment, and several adjacent verticals. The cohort includes publicly-traded enterprises, private holding companies, and family-owned businesses. All operate primarily in the United States.

WHAT WE MEASURED

The audit is based entirely on public-web observation: the homepage and one to two sub-pages per company, captured between April and May 2026. Each site was scored on 10 data points covering configurator presence, pricing visibility, path-to-price click count, primary buying path, quote-form friction, AI features, guided-selling flows, live chat, customer logos, and lead-time disclosure.

WHAT WE DIDN'T MEASURE

We did not interview buyers. We did not measure conversion outcomes. We did not access internal analytics, sales data, or first-party customer research. We did not survey dealers. The findings are about what manufacturers show on their websites, not about what works downstream of those websites.

WHY WE PUBLISH

We could not find this benchmark anywhere else. Trade publications cover brand and product news. Analyst firms benchmark technology stacks. Nobody looks systematically at what enterprise buyers actually find on manufacturer websites. We thought it was worth doing.

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What's In This Report?

Twelve chapters, structured to be read straight through or referenced by intent. Sections 04 and 06 are the most actionable.

01	Executive summary	<i>four findings</i>
02	The Buyer Enablement Score	<i>a single composite metric</i>
03	The channel finding	<i>a 9× score gap</i>
04	If you're trying to...	<i>five intents, five data cuts</i>
05	Capability heat map	<i>six verticals × five capabilities</i>
06	Score your own site	<i>10-question self-audit</i>
07	Vertical snapshots	<i>six core verticals in depth</i>
08	What the leaders share	<i>15 manufacturers showing prices</i>
09	Methodology	<i>how we audited</i>
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12	Companies in the cohort	<i>alphabetical list of 100</i>

01 What 100 Manufacturer Websites Tell You

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

If you sell configurable products through dealers, distributors, or reps, your website is doing a different job than buyers ask of it. Four findings, all consistent across verticals and company sizes.

FINDING 01

26%

26 / 100 · +12% partial

have a fully interactive product configurator on the homepage — 46% have nothing visible.

FINDING 02

15%

15 / 100 · 67% gate every \$

display product pricing without a transactional barrier — at least one dollar amount visible without filling out a form, calling sales, or contacting a dealer.

FINDING 03

12%

12 / 100 · 59% gated

have a low-friction quote-request form — accessible inline on the contact page, ≤ 8 fields. The other 72% bury the form behind multiple clicks, login, or have no public form at all.

FINDING 04 · HEADLINE

9x

channel-locked vs. direct/hybrid

median Buyer Enablement Score gap between channel-locked sites and sites with any direct or hybrid path — 0.50 vs. 4.50 median, the strongest predictor in the dataset.

All percentages are based on the 100-company cohort, excluding sites with static content, redirects to non-buyer-facing pages, bot-blocking destinations, JS-rendered shells, expired SSL certificates, or sites that could not be deeply audited. Those 16 sites are flagged in the methodology section and counted as “feature unconfirmed.”

CHAPTER 01 What 100 Manufacturer Websites Tell You

DEFINITIONS USED IN THIS REPORT

Configurator	An interactive 2D or 3D product tool that lets a buyer build, visualize, or spec a product before talking to a person. Includes "Build Your Own," visualizers, design studios, and component-pickers reachable from the homepage or a top-level product page.
AI feature	A homepage-reachable AI capability supporting the buying experience — for example: an AI-powered product visualizer, AI assistant or chatbot, AI-driven recommendation engine, or AI-color-matching tool. Excludes passive marketing-copy mentions of AI (counted separately).
Quote-form friction	How easy is it for a buyer to reach and complete a public quote-request form? LOW = inline form on contact page, ≤8 fields. MED = form requires 1 click from the contact page, or has 9+ fields. HIGH = form requires 2+ clicks or login. NONE = no public form (phone/email/dealer-only).
Direct purchase	Primary CTA leads to e-commerce checkout (e.g., "Shop Now" with cart, or product-page "Buy" buttons).
Hybrid	Multiple buying paths offered, including at least one self-serve option (e.g., a configurator next to a "Find a Dealer" link).
Contact sales	Primary CTA is "Get a Quote" or similar form-based lead capture.
Dealer-only	Primary CTA routes the buyer to a dealer/distributor locator with no other action available.
Corporate-only	Primary CTA leads to "About," "Investor Relations," or content marketing — no path to purchase.

DISTRIBUTION OF PRIMARY BUYING PATHS

Corporate-only (no buying path)	31	31%
Hybrid (multiple paths)	23	23%
Unaudited (technical errors)	16	16%
Dealer-only ("Find a Dealer")	14	14%
Direct purchase ("Shop Now")	12	12%
Contact sales ("Get a Quote")		3%
Other / unclear		1%

THE THESIS

Most enterprise manufacturer websites are still optimized for a buying motion that no longer fits how buyers research and decide. The dealer channel still closes the revenue. The website that hands buyers off to that channel is failing both.

Closing the gap doesn't require dismantling the dealer model. It requires giving the website the same job a dealer does: helping a buyer figure out what to buy.

02

One Number That Ranks the Category

We aggregated the 10 audit data points into a single weighted composite — the Buyer Enablement Score — on a 0 to 10 scale.

The score answers a single question: how much of the buyer journey can a first-time visitor actually complete on this manufacturer's website?

HOW THE BUYER ENABLEMENT SCORE IS CALCULATED

Ten weighted components covering the full buyer journey from first impression to quote request.

Configurator presence		2.0 pts
Pricing visibility		1.5 pts
Path-to-price		0.5 pt
Primary buying path		1.5 pts
Quote-form friction		1.0 pt
AI features		1.0 pt
Guided selling flow		1.0 pt
Live chat / AI assistant		0.5 pt
Customer logos visible		0.5 pt
Lead-time disclosed		0.5 pt

The Buyer Enablement Score is computed only for the 84 of 100 cohort companies with usable audit data. The 16 unaudited companies are excluded from the leaderboard but listed in the appendix.

A NOTE ON THE WEIGHTS

Weights were assigned to reflect what a first-time buyer most needs to evaluate a product: visibility into the offering (configurator, pricing) and a clear path to action (buying path, quote-form friction). Alternative weightings — for example, doubling the weight on quote-form friction or removing the configurator weight entirely — preserve the cohort distribution shape and the channel-locked vs. direct/hybrid gap. Specific company rankings shift modestly. Per-component scores for the top 10 leaders are published below so readers can apply their own weighting.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

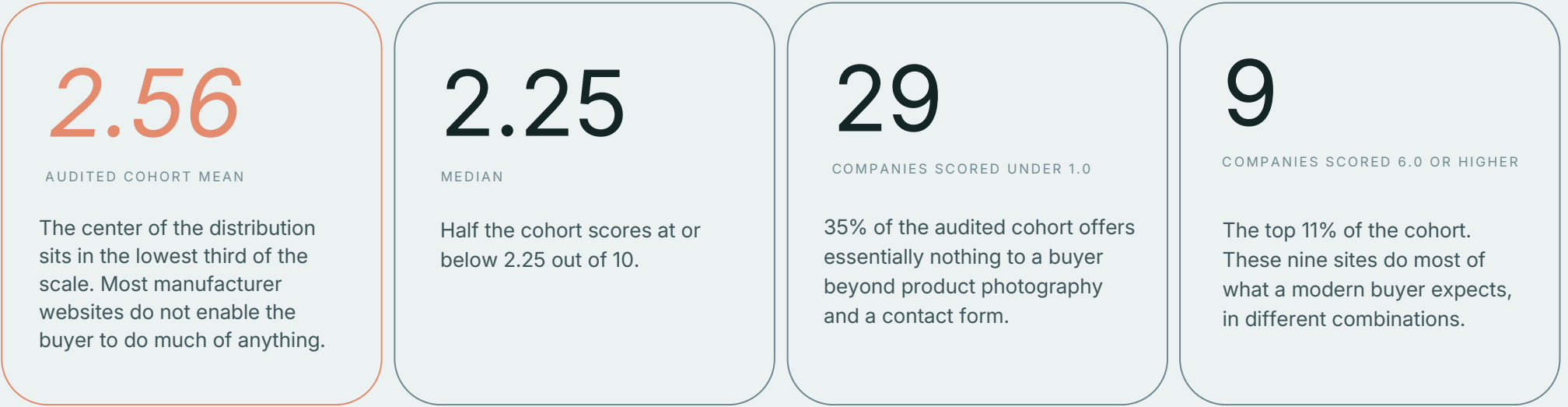
How a 7.50 *actually* breaks down

Yale Commercial (Doors & Windows, Buyer Enablement Score 7.50)—the joint cohort leader, scored across all ten components.

COMPONENT	WEIGHT	YALE COMMERCIAL OBSERVATION	SCORE
Configurator presence	2.0	"Smart Studio" — guided-selling quiz, not a full 3D configurator (Partial)	1.0
Pricing visibility	1.5	Public — \$99.99–\$309.99 visible on homepage product pages	1.5
Path-to-price	0.5	Visible at 0 clicks	0.5
Primary buying path	1.5	Direct purchase	1.5
Quote-form friction	1.0	LOW — inline form, ≤8 fields	1.0
AI features	1.0	None observed	0
Guided selling flow	1.0	Yes — Smart Studio quiz reachable from homepage	1.0
Live chat / AI assistant	0.5	24/7 support link on homepage	0.5
Customer logos visible	0.5	Integration partner logos on homepage	0.5
Lead-time disclosed	0.5	Not disclosed	0
Total			7.50

A reader applying alternative weights — for example, doubling quote-form friction and zeroing out configurator — would score Yale at 6.50, ClosetMaid at 5.50, and Schlage at 5.50. The leaderboard tightens but the channel-locked vs. direct/hybrid gap holds.

DISTRIBUTION ACROSS THE AUDITED COHORT



7.50

HIGHEST SCORE IN THE COHORT

Tied between Yale Commercial (Doors & Windows) and ClosetMaid (Cabinets & Closets).

Buyer Enablement Score leaderboard

Top of the audited cohort, ordered high to low. All ten leaders deliver a buyer at least one of: visible pricing, an interactive configurator, or a self-serve buying path. Per-component scores are shown so readers can apply their own weighting.

COMPANY	CFG	PRI	PTP	BPA	QFF	AI	GS	LC	CL	LT	TOTAL
Yale Commercial	1.0	1.5	0.5	1.5	1.0	0	1.0	0.5	0.5	0	7.50
ClosetMaid	2.0	1.5	0.5	1.5	1.0	0	1.0	0	0	0	7.50
American Standard Brands	2.0	1.5	0.5	1.0	1.0	0	1.0	0	0	0	7.00
fireclay tile	1.0	1.5	0.5	1.5	1.0	0	1.0	0	0.5	0	7.00
Kraus USA	1.0	1.5	0.5	1.5	1.0	0	1.0	0.5	0	0	7.00
Schlage	2.0	1.5	0.5	1.0	0.5	0	1.0	0	0	0	6.50
Hot Spring Spas	1.0	1.5	0.5	1.0	0.5	0	1.0	0.5	0.5	0	6.50
Jayco	1.0	1.5	0.5	1.0	0.5	0	1.0	0.5	0.5	0	6.50
Kubota Tractor Corporation	2.0	1.5	0.5	1.0	0.5	0	1.0	0	0	0	6.50
Overhead Door Corporation	1.0	0	0	1.0	0.5	1.0	1.0	0.5	0.5	0	5.50

Component key: Cfg = Configurator (max 2.0) · Pri = Pricing visibility (1.5) · Ptp = Path-to- price (0.5) · Bpa = Primary buying path (1.5) · Qff = Quote-form friction (1.0) · AI = AI features (1.0) · Gs = Guided selling (1.0) · Lc = Live chat (0.5) · Cl = Customer logos (0.5) · Lt = Lead-time disclosed (0.5).

Bottom Of The Cohort

29 audited companies(35% of audited cohort) scored under 1.0 — meaning a first-time buyer cannot configure a product, see a price, find a customer reference, or interact with anyone in real time without leaving the site. In keeping with this report's principle of naming leaders only, the bottom is summarized by vertical rather than by company name.

VERTICAL	COMPANIES SCORING < 1.0	% OF AUDITED VERTICAL
Heavy Machinery	5	100% of 5 audited
Foodservice Equipment	5	100% of 5 audited
Doors & Windows (corporate-only sites)	9	35% of 26 audited
Medical Equipment	2	50% of 4 audited
Cabinets & Closets (corporate-only sites)	2	29% of 7 audited
Powersports	2	29% of 7 audited
Kitchen & Bath / Plumbing	2	10% of 21 audited
Other verticals (Custom Uniforms, Funeral & Memorial)	2	50% of 4 audited

CHAPTER
03A 9x Score Gap Between
Channel-Locked and
Direct/Hybrid

When we compare manufacturers whose websites only route buyers through dealers or corporate landing pages against manufacturers whose websites offer any direct or hybrid path, the gap is dramatic.

CHANNEL-LOCKED SITES

N = 46 · 55% of audited cohort · Dealer-only or Corporate-only · Mean = 1.28

0.50 / 10

Median Buyer Enablement Score

A buyer landing here gets a "Find a Dealer" map, a "Get to Know Us" page, or a holding-company press release. They cannot evaluate a product, configure it, see a price, or initiate any kind of self-serve action.

DIRECT / HYBRID SITES

N=37·44% of audited cohort · Direct, hybrid, or contact-sales · Mean = 4.21

4.50 / 10

Median Buyer Enablement Score

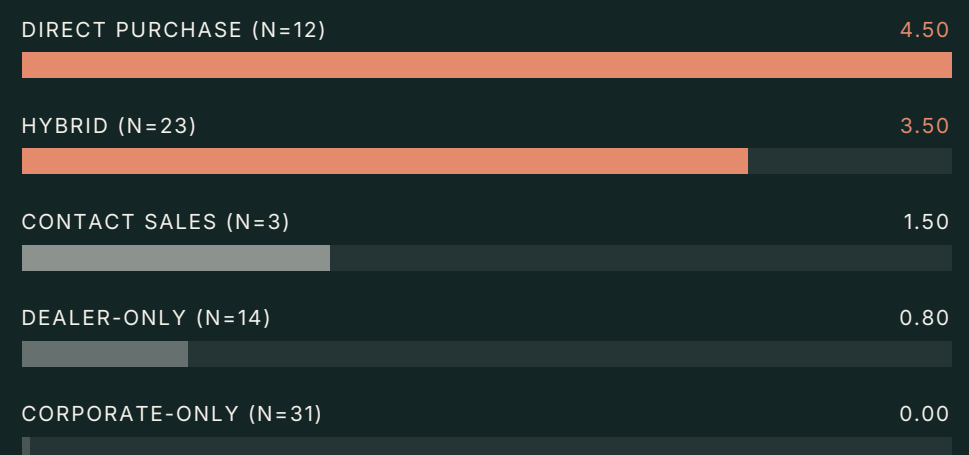
A buyer landing here finds at least one self-serve path: a configurator, a price, a "Get a Quote" CTA, or a "Shop Now" button. The dealer channel is still present — but it doesn't gate every interaction.

THE HEADLINE FINDING

The strongest predictor of a manufacturer's Buyer Enablement Score is *not vertical, company size, or AI presence*. It is whether the website offers any path to action that **does not require speaking to a person**.

Channel-locked sites score 9x lower than sites with any direct or hybrid path. The difference is not catalog depth or product complexity. It is that every interaction routes through a phone tree before a buyer can evaluate anything.

BUYING PATH × BUYER ENABLEMENT SCORE



04

Five Intents, *Five Data Cuts*

Different roles read different stats. Below: five common intents, the data cut that each, and the buyer-side function that typically owns the call.

i.

Improve conversion on your website

MOST OFTEN OWNED BY: DIGITAL / ECOMMERCE / TRANSFORMATION LEADERS — DIRECTOR, VP, SVP DIGITAL · HEAD OF DIGITAL EXPERIENCE · CDO

9x

Buyer Enablement Score lift from sites with a configurator or hybrid path versus sites without. Channel-locked sites (median 0.50) vs. direct/hybrid sites (median 4.50).

A homepage configurator is the single highest-leverage signal in the audit. Sites that have one, even a partial tool buried on a sub-page, outperform the rest by a factor that does not show up in any other variable. The configurator is the entry condition. Live AI features are the second-mover position, and only 4 of 100 manufacturers have taken it.

ii.

Reduce time-to-quote and cost-per-lead

MOST OFTEN OWNED BY: MARKETING / DEMAND GEN LEADERS — DIRECTOR DEMAND GEN · VP / SVP MARKETING · CMO

3.6x

Buyer Enablement Score gap between manufacturers showing pricing (mean 5.83) and those gating it (mean 1.62). Gating produces more raw lead volume; showing pricing produces more pre-qualified leads.

The form is generating leads. Most of them are info-seekers, not buyers. The 15 manufacturers showing prices generate fewer leads, but each lead arrives with budget acknowledged and alternatives narrowed. Website pipeline that dealers will actually work is downstream of giving the buyer enough information to opt in.

iii.

Free up sales reps from discovery work

MOST OFTEN OWNED BY: COMMERCIAL / SALES LEADERS — DIRECTOR SALES ENABLEMENT · VP / SVP SALES · CRO · CCO · GM

59%

of audited cohort gates the quote-request behind multi-step forms (1+ click off the contact page or 9+ fields). Another 15% has no public form at all and routes everything to dealers. Buyers arrive at sales without the basics already qualified.

Pre-qualified leads close faster. A buyer who arrives with the product configured, intent expressed, and price acknowledged shortens the rep's discovery cycle. The site's job is discovery; the rep's job is the close. The cohort's median primary CTA is "Learn More," which converts curiosity into a click but not a click into a quote. Reducing friction at the quote stage is the cheapest single move in this audit. 12 of 100 already do it with low-friction inline forms of 8 fields or fewer, and those manufacturers cluster in the top quartile of Buyer Enablement Score.

iv.

Cut mis-spec returns and warranty claims

MOST OFTEN OWNED BY: PRODUCT / CX LEADERS — DIRECTOR / VP PRODUCT · VP CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE

2 / 100

manufacturers disclose lead time on a public-facing page. Fabuwood ("as little as 5-day lead time on semi-custom") and Henry Schein ("9 in 10 Orders Arrive Next Day") are the only two. 80 audited manufacturers make the buyer ask before knowing whether the product ships in six weeks or twenty-six.

Visual configuration plus visible lead time addresses the two biggest sources of mis-spec returns: wrong configuration and wrong delivery expectations. Visual confidence at the decision point, before the buyer commits to a quote, cuts the order errors that show up months later in NPS and warranty data. Only 2 of 100 audited manufacturers disclose lead time, which is the size of the gap and the size of the opening for the next two or three to claim the position.

v.

Decide whether to build or buy your AI buyer experience layer

MOST OFTEN OWNED BY: IT / AI LEADERS — DIRECTOR / VP IT · CIO · HEAD OF AI · VP AI STRATEGY

4 / 100

manufacturers have a live AI feature on the website: Overhead Door (visualizer), Hörmann (A.I. Assistant), Fabuwood (Color AI), Symmons (Evolution Building Management). 4 more mention AI in marketing copy without surfacing it as a buyer tool.

The category is open because nobody has yet built the AI buyer-experience layer at scale. The buy decision is between a build (a configurator and AI stack from scratch, 12+ months, internal team, ongoing maintenance) and a vendor layer that sits on the existing stack with proper certifications and no third-party model training on your data. The few buyer-aware sites in this cohort took the second path.

CHAPTER

05

Six Core Verticals x

Five Capabilities

Where each vertical lights up, and where it doesn't. Each cell shows the percentage of audited manufacturers in that vertical with the named capability visible to a first-time buyer.

VERTICAL	CONFIGURATOR (ANY)	PRICING VISIBLE	PRICING VISIBLE	LIVE CHAT	LEAD-TIME DISCLOSED
Doors & Windows 26 audited · 34 in cohort	42%	12%	8%	12%	0%
Kitchen & Bath / Plumbing 21 audited · 23 in cohort	62%	29%	5%	5%	0%
Cabinets & Closets 7 audited · 7 in cohort	43%	29%	14%	0%	14%
Contract Furniture 2 audited · 4 in cohort	100%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Medical & Dental Equipment 4 audited · 5 in cohort	25%	0%	0%	0%	25%
Custom Uniforms / PPE 3 audited · 3 in cohort	33%	0%	0%	33%	0%

Heat scale: 0% = light, 1–15% = peach, 16–40% = pink, 41–70% = sage, 71–100% = dark sage. Powersports (median Buyer Enablement Score 4.5, N=7) leads the cohort on this dimension and is presented separately because the powersports buying motion (RVs,boats, motorcycles) is materially different from configurable B2B manufacturing.

WHAT THE HEAT MAP SHOWS

Configurator presence is the most consistent buyer-aware capability, found in 25 to 100% of every core vertical. Pricing visibility is rarer and concentrates in Kitchen & Bath and Cabinets, where designer-led and consumer- facing buying motions push manufacturers toward transparency. Live AI is essentially absent. Only two manufacturers in the cohort disclose lead time: Fabuwood in Cabinets and Henry Schein in Medical/Dental ("9 in 10 Orders Arrive Next Day"). Every other vertical is at zero on lead time.

CHAPTER
06

Run The Same Audit *On The Homepage*

Ten yes/no questions. Each "Yes" counts as one point. Total your score and compare yourself against the cohort below.

- | | | |
|----|--|-----------------------|
| 01 | Can a buyer see at least one product price on your homepage without filling out a form? | ☐ |
| 02 | Can a buyer configure or visualize a product (in 2D or 3D) before talking to anyone? | ☐ |
| 03 | Is your primary "how to buy" path clear within 5 seconds of landing — without "Find a Dealer" being the only option? | ☐ |
| 04 | Is your contact / quote-request form 8 fields or fewer? | ☐ |
| 05 | Do you show recent customers by name on your homepage or a customers page? | ☐ |
| 06 | Do you have a "build your own," product finder, or guided-selling quiz reachable from the homepage? | ☐ |
| 07 | Is current product availability or lead time visible on at least one product page? | ☐ |
| 08 | Can a buyer reach a live person (or AI) in fewer than 3 clicks? | ☐ |
| 09 | Can a buyer get a ballpark price without a sales call? | ☐ |
| 10 | Does your site mention how AI helps buyers — recommendations, search, configuration, or chat? | ☐ |

YOUR SCORE (OUT OF 10)

0–3 BOTTOM QUARTILE

of the audited cohort. The gap your buyers experience is wide enough to lose deals to a more buyer-ready competitor.

4–6 MIDDLE OF THE PACK

A handful of changes — most commonly visible pricing, a homepage configurator, or a "Get a Quote" flow under 8 fields — would move you into the top decile.

7–10 TOP QUARTILE

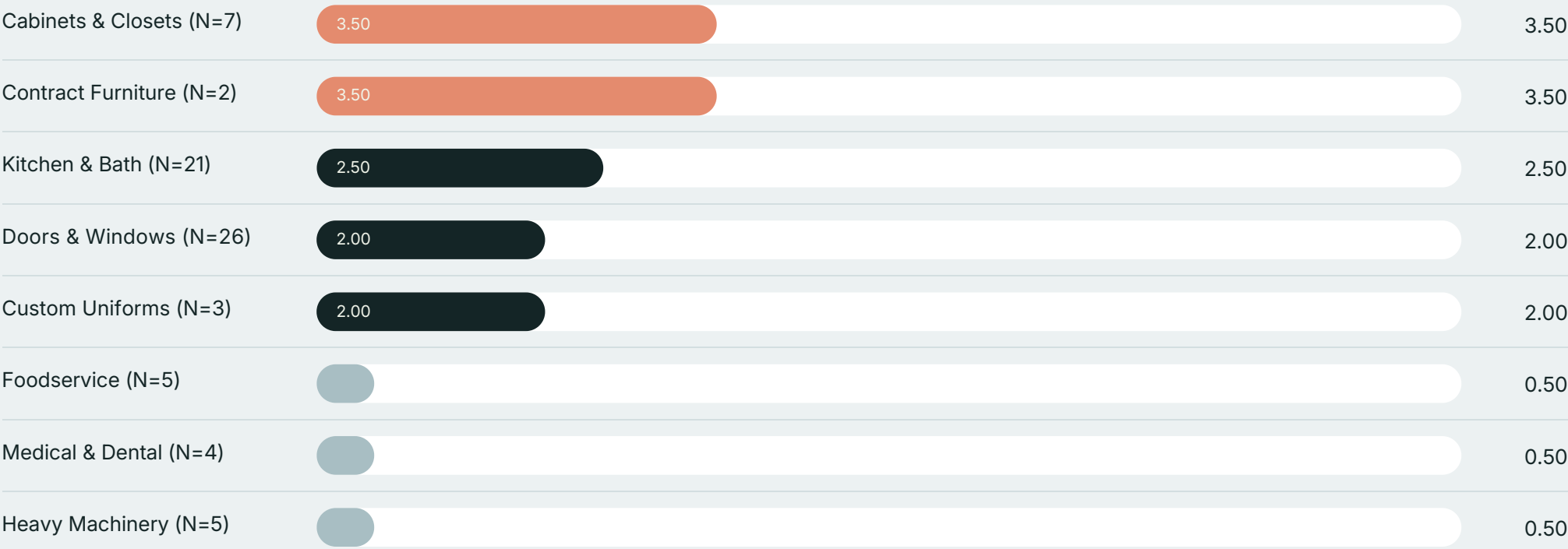
You are likely out-performing peers on web-to-lead. The remaining gaps in this report are still worth knowing.

CHAPTER
07

Six Core Verticals *In Depth*

The Buyer Enablement Score varies sharply by vertical. Verticals where buyers expect to research and configure online (Cabinets, Powersports, Kitchen & Bath) outperform verticals where institutional sales architecture still dominates (Heavy Machinery, Medical & Dental, Foodservice).

VERTICAL LEADERBOARD · MEDIAN BUYER ENABLEMENT SCORE



Doors & Windows

26 audited / 34 in cohort · median BES 2.00
best in vertical: **Yale Commercial** (BES 7.50)

5/26 HAVE A REAL CONFIGURATOR	3/26 SHOW PRICING ON HOMEPAGE	2/26 HAVE A LIVE AI FEATURE	14/26 ROUTE PRIMARY CTA TO "FIND A DEALER" OR CORPORATE PAGE
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The largest and most heterogeneous vertical in the cohort. Yale Commercial leads on every dimension:

- Visible pricing (\$99.99 to \$309.99)
- A "Smart Studio" guided-selling quiz
- Integration partner logos
- 24/7 support reachable from the homepage.

Schlage is close behind, with visible pricing, the Pin & Tumbler Studio configurator, and a "Take the Quiz" guided flow.

Most common gap: The "Where to Buy" CTA appears before any product evaluation tool. Buyers must commit to a dealer relationship before knowing whether the product fits.

Kitchen & Bath / Plumbing

21 audited / 23 in cohort · median BES 2.50
best in vertical: **Kraus USA** (BES 7.00)

9/21	8/21	2/21	38%
HAVE ANY CONFIGURATOR PRESENCE	SHOW PRICING ON HOMEPAGE	HAVE A LIVE AI OR LIVE CHAT	OF COHORT WITH VISIBLE PRICING — HIGHEST IN AUDIT

Kitchen & Bath has the highest pricing-visibility rate in the cohort. Kraus USA shows priced products on the homepage with a Spring Sale promo. Hot Spring Spas displays MSRPs from \$4,999 to \$26,999 alongside a "Help Me Choose" tool and an AR companion app. Waterworks anchors the luxury end with fixtures priced at \$12,500. American Standard offers a Visualizer + Room Planner with visible product pricing.

Most common gap: Inspiration above pricing. Many sites lead with award lists, designer credits, and hospitality references — even when the buyer is qualified to purchase.

Cabinets & Closets

7 audited / 7 in cohort (vertical complete) · median BES 3.50
best in vertical: **ClosetMaid** (BES 7.50)

5/7	2/7	1/7	1/7
HAVE A CONFIGURATOR	SHOW PRICING ON HOMEPAGE	HAVE A LIVE AI FEATURE (FABUWOOD)	DISCLOSE LEAD TIME (FABUWOOD)

The Cabinets vertical has the highest configurator-presence rate in the cohort. ClosetMaid (via homebyames.com) leads with two design tools and visible pricing \$149.99–\$602.94. Fabuwood is the cohort's only company that combines a Cabinet Visualizer, a Color AI feature, and disclosed lead time ("as little as 5-day lead time on semi-custom"). California Closets shows budget tiers (\$1,904–\$10,949) without a self-service configurator.

Most common gap: Two of seven sites are corporate / IR pages for parent holding companies, with no buyer-facing path to the children brands.

Contract Furniture

2 audited / 4 in cohort · median BES 3.50
best in vertical: **KI** (BES 3.50)

2/2	0/2	2/2	100%
HAVE A CONFIGURATOR	SHOW PRICING ON HOMEPAGE	SHOW NAMED CUSTOMER LOGOS	OF AUDITED SUBSET WITH CONFIGURATOR

The smallest vertical, but with the highest configurator density. KI offers See It Spec It (Cogni Seating), Classroom Planner, and a Square Foot Calculator. Haworth's "Design Your Own" tool sits alongside named customer logos (UbiSoft, Honeywell, Softchoice). Both companies use the website as a design-resource layer for an architect/designer audience — pricing remains gated.

Most common gap: Configurators are buried in resource libraries instead of surfaced on the homepage. The buyer who lands first sees brand inspiration, not the design tool.

Note: 2 of 4 cohort companies returned bot-blocks during the audit; these are excluded.

Medical & Dental Equipment

4 audited / 5 in cohort · median BES 0.50
best in vertical: Henry Schein (BES 4.50)

1 /4	0 /4	1 /4	25%
HAS ANY CONFIGURATOR (MIDMARK, VET ONLY)	SHOW PRICING ON HOMEPAGE	DISCLOSES LEAD TIME (HENRY SCHEIN)	WITH SELF-SERVE BUYING PATH

Institutional sales architecture dominates. Henry Schein is the standout — direct purchase path ("Shop Now"), 300,000+ products, "9 in 10 Orders Arrive Next Day" lead-time disclosure, and partial AI mention. Midmark segments by Medical / Dental / Veterinary, with the only configurator (Cage Bank) confined to the veterinary section. Owens & Minor reads as a healthcare-logistics enterprise site, not a buyer-facing brand.

Most common gap: Selling to procurement officers, not to researchers. Most of the vertical assumes a relationship and a sales cycle, not a self-directed buyer with a question.

Note: 1 of 5 cohort companies (Medtronic) returned canvas-only content and is excluded.

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Custom Uniforms / PPE

3 audited / 3 in cohort (vertical complete) · median BES 2.00
best in vertical: Vestis (BES 5.50)

1 /3	1 /3	12	0 /3
HAS A CONFIGURATOR (VESTIS)	HAS LIVE HUMAN CHAT (VESTIS)	NAMED CUSTOMER LOGOS VISIBLE (UNIFIRST)	SHOW PRICING ON HOMEPAGE

All three sites default to "Get a Quote" as the primary CTA. The quote-led motion fits the contract-size economics of the vertical. Vestis is the most buyer-aware site here, with a 3-step service builder and live human chat. UniFirst has the cohort's deepest named-customer logo gallery: Coca-Cola, Costco, Stellantis, Target, Hershey's, Bristol Myers Squibb, Land O'Lakes, Ryder, Shell, Whole Foods, CarMax, and Hendrick Automotive. AlSCO trails on both dimensions.

Most common gap: No price visibility. The journey from "I'm looking" to "I'm quoted" is undifferentiated across the three.

CHAPTER 08

15 Manufacturers Showing Prices

Of 84 audited manufacturer websites, 15 (15% of the 100- company cohort) display at least one product price without a transactional barrier. The 67 others gate every dollar figure behind a quote form, dealer locator, or designer relationship. The 15 exceptions span luxury bath, hardware, faucets, hot tubs, RVs, closets, tile, shades, and tractors. They have very little in common as products. They have a great deal in common in how they treat the buyer.

COMPANY	VERTICAL	PRICING OBSERVED	BES
Yale Commercial	Doors & Windows	\$99.99 – \$309.99	7.50
ClosetMaid	Cabinets & Closets	\$149.99 – \$602.94	7.50
American Standard Brands	Kitchen & Bath	\$387.40 (faucet)	7.00
fireclay tile	Flooring / Surfaces	\$13 – \$34 / sq ft	7.00
Kraus USA	Kitchen & Bath	\$449.95 – \$649.95	7.00
Schlage	Doors & Windows	\$20.99 – \$329	6.50
Hot Spring Spas	Kitchen & Bath	\$4,999 – \$26,999	6.50
Jayco	Powersports	\$17,318 – \$407,100	6.50
Kubota Tractor Corporation	Heavy Machinery	\$12,798 – \$109,390 (MSRP)	6.50
The Shade Store	Doors & Windows	\$270 – \$400	5.50
Yamaha Motor USA	Powersports	\$1,899 – \$27,899	4.50
Waterworks	Kitchen & Bath	\$911 – \$12,500	4.50
DXV by American Standard	Kitchen & Bath	\$364 – \$6,058	4.00
California Closets	Cabinets & Closets	\$1,904 – \$10,949 (tiered)	3.00
Sundance Spas	Kitchen & Bath	\$0 – \$16,000+ (5-tier)	2.50

WHAT THE 15 SHARE

Across products that span \$20 door locks and \$407,100 motorhomes, the 15 price-visible manufacturers behave differently from the 67 that gate pricing in three respects. *They treat price as a confidence signal rather than an objection.* They preserve the channel relationship through a different mechanism (designer consultations at Waterworks and the Shade Store, dealer locators at Yamaha, Jayco, and Kubota, budget-tier filtering at California Closets) rather than making the price the gating event. And their average Buyer Enablement Score is **5.83**, more than 2× the cohort median.

09

How We Audited, *What We Measured, What We Didn't*

We selected 100 of the largest and most recognizable configurable-product manufacturing companies in North America, intentionally weighted toward companies with non-trivial channel structures (dealers, distributors, reps) and configurable physical products. The cohort was identified through a combination of public revenue rankings, trade-association member lists, and category coverage across the verticals where configurable selling is most material. The cohort is heterogeneous across company size, public/private status, and family ownership. It is not a probability sample of all configurable-product manufacturers; findings generalize to the cohort, not to the universe.

VERTICAL DISTRIBUTION

Doors & Windows (34 in cohort, 26 audited), Kitchen & Bath / Plumbing (23 / 21), Powersports (8 / 7), Cabinets & Closets (7 / 7 — vertical complete), Heavy Machinery (7 / 5), Foodservice Equipment (6 / 5), Medical & Dental Equipment (5/ 4), Contract Furniture (4 / 2), Custom Uniforms / PPE (3 / 3 — vertical complete), Funeral & Memorial (1 / 1), Flooring/Surfaces (1 / 1), and one unclassified entry. 84 of 100 sites yielded usable audit data; 16 returned bot-blocks, JS-rendered shells without static content, redirects to non-buyer-facing destinations, or expired SSL certificates and are excluded from quantitative findings.

THE 10 DATA POINTS

Each audited site was scored on: (1) Configurator presence — interactive product visualization or build-your-own tool, scored Yes / Partial / No; (2) Pricing visibility — whether at least one product price is displayed without form submission, scored Public / Partial / Gated; (3) Path-to-price — clicks from homepage to a dollar figure, derived from pricing visibility; (4) Primary buying path — Direct purchase / Hybrid / Contact sales / Dealer-only / Corporate-only; (5) Quote-form friction — LOW / MED / HIGH / NONE based on form depth, field count, and accessibility; (6) AI features visible on homepage — Live AI / Mentioned only / None; (7) Guided selling flow — quiz, finder, or step-by-step tool, Yes / No; (8) Live chat or AI assistant; (9) Customer logos count — named customer references; (10) Lead-time disclosure on product pages.

THE BUYER ENABLEMENT SCORE

The Buyer Enablement Score is a composite of all 10 audit data points, weighted to total 10 points. Quote-form friction was determined by inline-form analysis on the contact page for a verified subset and rules-based classification for the remainder, derived from observed primary buying path and CTA structure. Component definitions and weights are listed in section 02.

LIMITATIONS WE NAME IN PRINT

- i. The cohort is a sample of large/recognizable manufacturers, not a probability sample. Findings generalize to the cohort, not to the universe of all enterprise manufacturers.
- ii. "Configurator," "AI features," and "guided selling" are categorical classifications based on direct observation by the audit team. Scoring was performed during the April–May 2026 window, and classification-boundary cases were rescored after a one-week interval to check for consistency. Inter-rater consistency was monitored qualitatively but not formally quantified; readers reweighting the components themselves can apply the per-component data published in section 02.
- iii. Sites returning bot-blocks or JS-rendered shells without static content yielded "Unknown" outcomes. We retried via headless browser and parent- company URLs; some still failed and are excluded from quantitative claims.
- iv. The Buyer Enablement Score is a composite. Sensitivity to component weightings has not been published; alternative weightings would shift specific company rankings while preserving the cohort distribution shape.

WHAT WE DID NOT MEASURE

Buyer-side research.
We did not interview buyers about what they look for or what frustrates them. The audit captures what manufacturers show, not what works downstream of those websites.

Conversion outcomes.
We did not access internal analytics, sales data, or first-party conversion measurements. Where we infer commercial impact, we say so explicitly.

Dealer feedback.
We did not survey dealers or distributors about their relationship to the manufacturer's website.

Mobile parity.
The audit captured desktop-rendered homepages. Mobile-specific differences are out of scope for this edition.

Time-series data.
The audit is a single snapshot taken in April–May 2026. Manufacturer websites change frequently; specific findings may shift over time.

CHAPTER

10

Three Patterns *From The Leaders*

The 19 manufacturers in the top quartile of the Buyer Enablement Score (5.0 or higher) span six different verticals. They share three patterns the rest of the cohort doesn't.

01

Price as a confidence signal, not an obstacle

13 of 19 top-quartile manufacturers show at least one product price on the homepage. The standard objection ("we'll undercut our channel") is not what the data shows. Most price-visible leaders preserve the channel relationship through a different mechanism: designer consultations, dealer locators, or budget-tier filters. None of them does it by hiding the price. The buyer who sees a price filters themselves in.

02

A self-serve path next to the dealer path, not instead of it

Only 12 of 100 sites have direct purchase as the primary path. 23, including most top-quartile leaders, have a hybrid path: a configurator next to a "Find a Dealer," a "ShopNow" next to a quote form, a "Build Your Own" next to a showroom locator. The website becomes the on-ramp. The dealer still closes the deal. The buyer arrives qualified rather than cold.

03

Tools, not just product pages

The top quartile includes a Visualizer, a Cabinet Visualizer, a Color AI, a 3D Deck Designer, a "Take the Quiz" guided flow, a "Help Me Choose" tool, a "See It Spec It" component, an AR companion app, a Pin & Tumbler Studio, and a "BUILD" tractor configurator. The cohort's most consistent under-quartile sites have polished product photography and nothing for a buyer to do with it.

Configurators correlate more strongly with Buyer Enablement Score than any other variable.

CHAPTER

11

Forward-Looking Questions

Three questions the public web doesn't answer that future research could tackle.

QUESTION 01

Conversion outcomes

What's the lift on lead quality and quote-to-close from each of the 10 data points? Manufacturers willing to share anonymized funnel data alongside their public-web score could answer this directly.

QUESTION 02

Buyer-side reality

Structured interviews with manufacturer-side buyers, walking through their last evaluation cycles. What do they actually look for? Where do they bail?

QUESTION 03

Dealer-channel impact

How do top-quartile manufacturers' dealers feel about the website? Does a buyer-aware homepage strengthen or strain the dealer relationship?

Threekit published this research because we work in this category and could not find a comparable benchmark. If you would like to discuss the findings or suggest companies for a future cohort, reach us at contact@threekit.com.

FROM THREEKIT

The *90-day* Pilot

If reading this audit prompted a "we should fix that" thought, Threekit offers a 90-day Pilot. We collaborate to get a guided selling experience live on your site in 90 days, sitting on top of your existing stack with no third-party model training on your data.

[Learn More](#)

CHAPTER 12

Companies *in the Cohort*

Alphabetical list of all 100 enterprise manufacturers included in the May 2026 audit. Companies excluded from quantitative findings due to bot-blocks, JS-rendered shells, redirects, or SSL issues are noted with an asterisk.

- Allegion/Schlage
- Alside
- Alsco Uniforms
- American Standard Brands *
- Aquatic Bath
- ASSA ABLOY Door Group*
- Atrium Windows and Doors
- AZEK Company (TimberTech)
- Bradley Corporation *
- Brizo
- California Closets
- Ceco Door (ASSA ABLOY)*
- ClosetMaid
- Cornerstone Building Brands
- Curries (ASSA ABLOY)
- Dexter Axle (DexKo Global)
- Dormakaba USA
- Duke Manufacturing
- DXV by American Standard
- EMCO Enterprises (Andersen)*
- ES Windows*
- Fabuwood Cabinetry Corp
- Fiberon fireclay tile
- Forest River
- Gerber Plumbing Fixtures*
- Genie (TerexAWP)
- Hafele America Co *
- Haworth
- Hayward Pool Products
- Henry Schein
- Hobart Corporation (ITW)
- Hörmann USA
- Hot Spring Spas (Watkins/Masco)
- Humanscale
- Husqvarna Group North America
- ITW Food Equipment Group
- JELD-WEN, Inc.
- JLG Industries
- Jayco
- John Deere Construction & Forestry
- KI
- Kolbe and Kolbe Millwork
- Kolbe Windows & Doors *
- Kraus USA *
- Kubota Tractor Corporation
- Kwikset (Spectrum Brands)
- LCN (Allegion)
- LiftMaster (Chamberlain Group)*
- Manitowoc Foodservice (Welbilt)*
- Mansfield Plumbing Products
- MasterBrand Cabinets
- Master Spas
- Matthews International Corporation
- Medtronic*
- Mercury Marine (Brunswick)*
- Middleby Corporation *
- Midmark Corporation
- MTI Baths
- ODL, Inc
- Oldcastle BuildingEnvelope
- Organized Living
- Overhead Door Corporation
- Owens & Minor
- Pentair
- PGT Windows(MiterBrands)
- Pfister Faucets
- Polaris Industries
- Polyglass USA Inc.
- Pool Corp / SCP
- ProVia
- Quanex
- Reeb Millwork
- Richelieu Hardware
- ROHL (House of Rohl)
- School Specialty*
- Sierra Pacific Industries*
- Snap-on Incorporated
- Steelcraft (Allegion)
- Stryker *
- Sundance Spas
- Symmons Industries
- The Shade Store
- Thor Industries
- TOTO USA
- ToroCompany
- TrackerMarine
- Trimlite LLC
- UniFirst Corporation
- US LBM
- Vestis Corporation
- Von Duprin (Allegion) *
- Waterworks *
- Watkins Wellness (Masco)* *
- Watts WaterTechnologies
- Wayne DaltonCorp.*
- Weather Shield Windows and Doors*
- Welbilt
- Yale Commercial (ASSAABLOY)
- Yamaha Motor CorporationUSA

* = company excluded from quantitative findings due to bot-block, JS-rendered shell, redirect to non-buyer-facing destination, or SSL/connectivity error during the audit period.